

Title: With the New Season Around the Corner, Here's a Big Guide to Wave Management Concepts

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

Hello everyone, the new season's around the corner, so I figured I'd make an educational guide of some sort. IDK how many people will even see this but I hope it's at least helpful to some people. This will mostly be in text format, but I have tried to put in video examples for concepts that might be harder to visualize. Anyways, wave management questions are a hot topic in this subreddit as well as other places. And while I don't think it's possible to draft up a decision tree or formula or something to make wave management choices, I do think there are a bunch of fundamental techniques and strategies that are important to understand in order to adapt and apply them into your own gameplay. And so, here I hope to try and illustrate **what** these wave management techniques, what the advantages and disadvantages of each are, **how** to execute them, and **when** to execute them. I've also included some more niche and more advanced tips as well. Hopefully this will be a worthwhile read if you're either looking to improve on your wave management skills, or pick up on some of the more niche tips scattered throughout. Lastly, I made this with newer and less experienced players in mind, so some of the content might seem like common sense to more veteran players, but for others it may not be.

A brief intro to me just for credentials sake is that I'm currently a mid-high masters top + mid main (better at top). I also climbed to d1 last season playing adc too. The things I'll talk about usually apply to all lanes (a bit less so mid), but I will be focusing slightly more on top because that's the lane where wave management matters and is present the most. I'm also just a bit more familiar with top as well anyways. Obviously I'm not a perfect player and have a lot to learn myself, but I do hope some of the things I've learned and listed in this guide can be helpful for others.

Anyways, here's a table of contents for this post so you can skip to the parts you might be interested

in since this will probably be a bit long:

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- * **freezing**

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- * **What to do after a kill**

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- * **Trick to farm but never interact with your opponent in a bad matchup/when losing**

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- * **Method to push your lead - (During Laning) pressuring the enemy beyond their turret**

- * **Pulling waves**

- * **Quick level 1 wave tip for the melee vs ranged solo lane matchup**

- * **EXP**

- * **Proxying**

- * **Killing minions at the last possible split second**

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IMPORTANT NOTE: So before everything, I just wanna say that you SHOULD NOT take the examples I give throughout this as an end all be all. There's a ton of factors which can influence

these things, like items, matchup, jungle proximity, etc. etc. Just be aware of this.

WHY IS WAVE MANAGEMENT SO IMPORTANT?

Now to most people who've been playing League for awhile, this might be pretty obvious but for others maybe not so much so I just wanna give some perspective as to why you would want to work on wave management in the first place.

To begin, your greatest source of income throughout the game as a laner WILL be through minions. Even at the very start of the game, a single wave on average is worth a bit over 100 gold which only increases as the game goes on. This means every 20 cs you're down as a laner is pretty much equivalent to more than a kill! So just by improving your cs, partially through better wave management, you can increase your impact on games by A LOT.

Wave management directly correlates to more gold, primarily through higher cs scores. In the most simple and straightforward sense, mismanaging your wave will result in more of enemy minions dying while you are unable to last hit them or be near to even soak the exp. But in addition it can also set you up for kills and avoid kills yourself.

To put in more perspective, if say you mismanage the wave even a little bit; you auto an extra time, you reset too late, etc. you could easily lose a wave of minions, and sometimes even multiple waves if say it ends up allowing your opponent to freeze. Or it could lose you the opportunity to further push your lead and deny your opponent resources.

Do this just a couple times in a game and you're losing out on kills worth of gold in a game just from poor wave management.

3 FUNDAMENTAL WAVE MANAGEMENT TECHNIQUES

Firstly I just want to note a couple of things which you should understand beforehand:

****Waves naturally bounce back and forth between towers like ping pong when left alone.**** They crash to a tower, the tower kills them, then it starts pushing the other way. Why? because the minion waves on the tower's side will arrive at the minion crash site earlier than the enemy minions -> they start doing damage earlier -> more minions on that side -> push away.

****And so when you look at the lane state, you'll know the wave will eventually push a certain direction based on mainly 2 things:****

- * Minion crash location
- * Number+types of minions on both sides

****However, a couple ways the push power of a wave can be influenced:****

- * Autoing
- * Using abilities
- * Managing minion aggro (eg. if you hit your opponent the enemy minions will aggro you -> less damage on your wave -> faster pushing; This isn't really used though. Or the opposite your opponent hits you the wave will push more into you)
- * Stopping your opponent from hitting the wave
- * Manipulating minion targeting through pulling wave (will talk about later)

With enough experience, you can look at a lane state and instantly know what's going to happen to it.

SLOW PUSHING

WHAT IS SLOWPUSHING?

So I see this question get asked a lot actually, how most people answer this is: "*just last hit*". But that's not entirely accurate because then the followup question everyone asks is "**well then what do I do when the enemy is also hitting the wave?**" And sometimes, last hitting isn't enough even when an enemy isn't there; for example if a stacked wave is pushing against you.

So what slow pushing really is is damaging the wave such that it ends up pushing away from you in the most minimal way possible. How much you need to damage the wave is entirely situational.

HOW DO YOU SLOWPUSH?

How much you should be hitting the wave is entirely situational and will honestly just come with more games played. You need to judge the enemy dps on your own wave and use that to determine how much to deal back.

But for example take a look back at the part where the things you can do to influence push power was talked about. So if your opponent is full autoing and you want to slow push, you need to full auto + use an ability every now and then; or you can use your abilities more often/on more minions; or you can force your opponent off the wave and then only last hit; etc etc.

One good tip I have though is that if you have aoe abilities, you can try to get the most value out of them by hitting the wave AND the enemy at the same time. This can also give you surprising level ups that catch your opponent off guard.

It can get more nuanced than this though. For example in top lane some matchups level 1 entirely depend on proc'ing bone plating. So even if you want to push for level 2 first, you may want to prioritize popping the enemy BP first before focusing on the wave since you know you can win the all in if the enemy BP is down.

Lastly, remember to not tunnel vision on slowpushing. Don't use an ability to get a faster push if you need it to deter or win a trade unless you really think the advantage will outweigh the cost.

****SO WHAT DOES IT DO FOR YOU?****

1. ****Get a good reset****. You can guarantee the crash, reset, and come back to lane with an item advantage. Because it's a huge wave, most champs will take a lot longer to clearing it meaning they will have to choose to either lane against you with an item disadvantage or reset right after clearing it resulting in blown tp, or some lost cs by the time they walk back. It also puts you in position to set up a freeze when you walk back to lane. It also means your wallet will be bigger when you do crash which can help get a more optimal back timer.
2. Big wave crash = longer to clear = ****longer roam/invade timer.****
3. ****Big wave crash = better dives**** (since it's harder to clear minions to get safe so you have more time to set it up AND because fighting back means more minions will aggro enemy) PLUS more minions lost if the dive turns successful
4. ****Slow push slow push fast push****: This is a common thing you can do to crash waves. You slow push right up until you know that if you fast push the current wave it crashes into enemy tower. This

maximizes the time you spend closer to your tower, and minimizes the time spent closer to enemy tower. This can keep you slightly safer against ganks. It also prevents awkward situations where you fast push a wave too early and the the next wave crashes right outside enemy turret or enemy ends up being able to freeze (cause the wave is too small).

5. ****NICHE USE** for never interacting in a bad matchup or losing state (Expanded in Miscellaneous section)******

However, slow pushing takes ****time.**** If you choose to slow push you may end up still trying to shove the wave when your presence is needed elsewhere even if you start hard shoving once you realize.

****SO WHEN SHOULD YOU SLOW PUSH?****

Most of the times:

1. When you want to use one of the advantages stated previously
2. If you know that even if you fast push it won't crash and the wave will end up in an awkward undesirable spot.

Usually if you don't really have any proactive intentions and you don't want to/can't fast push or freeze, you'll slow push cause of #4 in the section on what slowpushing does for you.

HARD SHOVING

****WHAT IS HARD SHOVING?****

This is easiest of the 3. Hard shoving is simply shoving the wave as fast as possible with the intention of crashing the wave as soon as possible.

****HOW DO YOU HARD SHOVE?****

Shoving the wave as fast as possible means full autoing + using all of your abilities.

Some tips which may or may not be completely obvious to you:

* Every single split second can count while hard shoving. ****Don't make the mistake of trying to save abilities unless you know someone is going to come stop you**** \- because that could mean you don't fully crash the wave and it ends up threatening into a freeze.

* Some examples of this: Using Fiora parry on the wave, Jax E, Using Vayne condemn (and also as an auto animation cancel). The half - couple seconds you gain DOES and WILL make a difference, especially as you climb higher.

* ****For the most part, kill the CASTERS FIRST.**** Why?

* They do the most damage, meaning they will trim your wave more if you leave them alive. They're squishier as well.

* If you kill the melees first, your minions will spend time walking forward rather than attacking while enemy minions are alive. It's a small difference, but overall it IS less efficient.

* The ONLY time you kill the melees first while you can target both is if your minions walking to the enemy casters will put them under enemy turret.

* ****Meet the wave as early as possible.**** If the wave is about to be neutral, but the minions haven't arrived yet, don't just sit and wait in the middle of the lane for the minions to arrive. Walk right outside the enemy tower range and start hitting and kiting the wave then.

* ****Landing aoe on as many minions as possible****

* **Get the most out of your high damage abilities.** I'll just give an example. Say you are playing camille. Don't waste your Q2 on a minion that's already at only 20 hp. Instead auto low minion -> Q2 a higher health minion. It sounds common sense when you say it, but a lot of people don't pay attention to it in the heat of things.

****SO WHAT DOES IT DO FOR YOU?****

****Well the main benefit is that it gets you the farm and pushes out the wave FAST**.** League can be thought of as a turn based game. When the waves bounce to your side of the map, it's the enemy's turn because otherwise you lose out on cs for trying to match. While the wave is on your side of the map it's the enemy's turn. So the faster you push it back, the faster you can begin your turn. Sure, it might mean your turn is shorter because not building a wave first means the enemy can clear it faster and shove it back, but sometimes you only need a couple seconds to make an impactful turn from getting to a fight just slightly earlier for example. And as talked about earlier, you can use the time while the enemy is catching the wave to do things like roam, reset, vision control.

It also helps you crash the wave, it also means your opponent has less time to catch it whether that be they're on a reset or roam.

****SO WHEN SHOULD YOU HARD SHOVE?****

1. ****Continuously hard shove if you want to poke.**** The easiest time to poke an enemy is when they're csing. It's also harder to poke if you also need to focus on csing. This is partly why you see a lot of ranged tops and poke bot lanes constantly shoving. (The other part is cause it's pretty tough to freeze for most ranged champs anyways)

2. ****You need to be somewhere ASAP****

3. ****You can crash the wave once you clear the current one and want to leave after**** (to reset, roam, etc.)

FREEZING

****WHAT IS FREEZING?****

Freezing is pretty much just manipulating the minion count (and your dps on the enemy wave) such that if you maintain those numbers the wave won't push in either way forever. You always want the crash zone (the place where the two waves meet; also a term I just made up 1 second ago so I can reuse it later for simplicity lol) on your side of the lane.

****HOW DOES A FREEZE WORK?****

Your goal is for the enemy side to always have more wave dps than yours so that your wave will always be wiped but the enemy wave will have minions left. To prevent these leftover minions from crashing into your turret, the next wave needs to either arrive before they move much or before your wave gets wiped (If not, you have the option to hold/pull the wave which is talked about later). In this way not only will waves continuously meet on your side of the lane, but your minions will also naturally all die. However, because the crash zone is closer to your turret (and therefore closer to your nexus where minions spawn) you need more than just a single minion disadvantage since your minions will always arrive at the crash zone earlier than the enemies which increases your side's wave dps. The enemy needs enough extra minions to offset this. So there is a minimum number of enemy minions you need to leave alive to maintain a freeze. It's not just simply more than yours.

****HOW DO YOU FREEZE?****

This is the hardest one.

The most common way people will answer this is talk about the 4 caster minion rule of thumb. What that is is basically leaving 4 enemy casters alive during each wave while you have none to maintain a freeze. The reason why you don't leave melees alive is because their attacks and targeting is wack and honestly somewhat rng. They will sometimes just randomly walk and target something and end up in turret range. Anyways, when the next waves arrives, you'll be able to only last hit minions and it will end in 4 or more enemy casters and none of your minions. Obviously this means to set it up in the first place the enemy needs to have more dps on your wave (either there needs to be more enemy minions already or an enemy needs to be hitting your wave or combination of both). Generally, this happens when the wave bounces back from the enemy turret and pushes towards you.

But when you put this into practice, you'll find yourself actually breaking this freeze quite quickly. Why? Because if you go for poke with any aoe ability you're likely to hit the wave at the same time. Or you hit the enemy and take aggro which allows your wave to survive longer. And because 3-4 minions is the minimum you need to maintain most freezes, you dealing more than necessary damage on the wave just breaks it. Even if you don't hit any minions, you'll still take minion aggro, which can also break the freeze. (btw this doesn't mean you can't damage the wave at all ever, if the enemy hits your wave, you can hit his back and get away with it).

So instead, you should usually freeze with as many minions as you can manage or on the higher end of it. This means you need to find a balance. You can't just freeze on a 20 minion slow push your opponent has built up - he'll just stat check you with his wave and force it to shove in. Thin out the wave to a point where you think you can force it to stay there. This way you have leeway to poke

and for other small mistakes (maybe you hit the wave by accident or a melee runs into tower range).

[This is a great, short, and to the point video which explains what I mean](<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0QtegdJpWWA>).

It's also just a good example of freezing as well.

Another really important tip is to ****pull the wave**** if the next one hasn't arrived yet. You take aggro and so the minions don't move forward and ending up in turret range. The next wave comes and you can drop aggro and the wave is further frozen. You can see Eragon in the above video doing the above in the video at [0:50](<https://youtu.be/0QtegdJpWWA?t=50>), [1:12](<https://youtu.be/0QtegdJpWWA?t=72>), [1:44](<https://youtu.be/0QtegdJpWWA?t=104>), and [2:17](<https://youtu.be/0QtegdJpWWA?t=137>). Obviously if you don't have sustain, you shouldn't do this for too long.

****SO WHAT DOES IT DO FOR YOU?****

Freezing prevents the wave from crashing into your turret and bouncing back towards the opponent.

What does this mean?

- * It forces your opponent to walk up if they want farm

- * They are forced to put themselves in a vulnerable position to farm or shove the wave in. This means ****gank set ups****.

- * If you're overwhelmingly stronger than your opponent, they can't even farm as ****you can zone them off the frozen wave.**** It's important to stand PAST the enemy casters so that they can't walk up. Use bush to toggle aggro and make sure to check them to make sure the enemy isn't soaking exp.

* You can **force all in angles** as they have to move further up the lane so you have more room to run them down.

* **It can keep you safe from ganks** as you're close to your turret and generally away from gank angles (CAREFUL OF LANE GANKS THOUGH, though junglers don't really do this till mid elo)

HOWEVER, some disadvantages:

* While it keeps you safe from ganks, **it doesn't from dives**. If the enemy somehow manages to shove in the wave, you're in perfect position to get dove.

* **If you DO die** somehow it is TERRIBLE for you because the enemy shoves the wave in and **you lose out on soo much farm.**

* **If the enemy decides to leave lane and roam, you can't follow** unless you shove out the wave first. BUT THAT DOESN'T MEAN YOU ALWAYS HAVE TO SHOVE IF YOU SEE THE ENEMY ROAMING. [(Since it already exists, here's another video from Eragon which explains it super well)](<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1acsDI2kkC4>). And yes I am an Eragon fan; he makes amazing content.

* On that note, do be careful of all ins because **your opponent will have minion advantage and you probably won't have much vision in the area** so if an ally is lying in wait you're screwed.

SO WHEN SHOULD YOU FREEZE?

1. If you think the overall advantage that you'd gain from freezing (stuff listed above) would outweigh the overall advantages gained from shoving. I know this is a very general answer and maybe not as specific as you'd like but there are just so many factors that are in league there's no way I can cover all of them and what would be better in each. You shouldn't just be memorizing scenarios like chess opening lines anyways, rather you should always be adapting your play to the situation.

2. ****You can also threaten freezes**** even if you know the enemy can break it! If you see your opponent wants to reset after finishing off a wave, you can pull/hold it and possibly force them to stay another wave if they can't force you back and push you off of it in time.

****BREAKING FREEZES****

Okay so what about if your opponent freezes on you instead?

Well obviously the best solution to this problem is avoid getting frozen on in the first place. But sometimes this is unavoidable due to matchups, or being weakside, or you just made mistakes in lane.

Unfortunately, there's no fool proof response to breaking freezes, after all freezing wouldn't be such a strategy if it was so easily countered. But there are a couple of things you can do that might work.

1. ****Bait the enemy into trading while the wave is bouncing.**** Instead of waiting until it's already frozen on the other side of the lane, you bait them into a trade into your wave while it's bouncing back and you're closer to your turret. A lot of players will greed for this. As a result your wave is chipped and no longer pushes away.

2. On a similar note if it's already frozen, ****Bait the the enemy into using their aoe abilities on the wave.**** This is more risky as you can more easily get run down if you overstep, unlike the previous bullet where you're closer to your turret. This is pretty tough to do bot lane in the 2v2, but is definitely something that works against many players top and mid. You just need to try and not get too chunked or all ined. The best time to do this if you anticipate the enemy will freeze on you is during the initial bounce back.

3. ****Die to fix the wave.**** This sounds troll af, but in some cases for top laners its worth if you're

ALSO getting zoned off exp. If you don't do anything, you'll end up losing way more than 300 gold worth of exp and farm over time. You just walk up clear as much of the wave as you can, and make the enemy run after you away from the wave to secure the kill. You'll most likely very very rarely need to do this, but it can happen.

4. ****Reset for an hp and item advantage.**** If you have gold to spend, or feel you can win an all in after a back, just reset and come back. Yes you sac minions, but it's better than bleeding out from a freeze even more.

5. ****Pray your opponent fucks it up.****

****Note****: For top lane, a lot of people will commonly say to ROAM when you're frozen on but a lot of the times it's not worth unless you're something like quinn or camille with both high mobility AND powerful ganks. Or you're team is getting rolled and you need to make a high risk high reward play. Otherwise you're sacking multiple waves of minions + possibly plates for a small **chance** at getting a kill or two back which isn't even worth what you lost even if successful. What ends up happening half the time anyways is you come back and the wave is either still frozen (as described earlier & with the Eragon vid), or the enemy has crashed the wave into turret, taken plates, and guess what?? The wave simply bounces back and he freezes again! You would have been better off soaking exp instead if you're team is doing reasonably fine. There is no need to let him shove get free plates and accelerate his lead even more for a meh success rate roam. Top isn't like mid lane where you're playing mobile champions with easy access to a lane with two squishy underleveled targets (and other factors that makes freezes less powerful).

BUT there I guess is the argument that players might actually get baited into breaking freezes and shoving if you walk out of vision for a bit. I've actually done this before and was kinda surprised it worked. It won't work more than once in a game though most likely.

APPLICATION EXAMPLE

Let's walk through a scenario shall we.

Take a look at this [scenario](https://imgur.com/a/BCDehMy) (we are blue side; pretend the top side camps are up). [Zoomed in version of lane.](https://imgur.com/a/yYp651i) Excuse my terrible photoshop skillz.

Some observations + assumed facts for this specific scenario:

- * The wave is just bouncing back
- * Your Jungler is pathing towards top side from base but his camps are all up
- * Let's assume that you are stronger than your opponent at this time (either cause champ diff, item diff, hp diff, etc.)

Okay, so we are going to cook up a game plan.

One line of thought could be:

1. We are stronger so we have more control over the wave state and want to set it up in a way that's most advantageous towards us. First thing that comes to mind is a freeze.
2. But the wave is pushing away from us, how can we make it freeze eventually? Well, we can get the wave to bounce back from the enemy turret and then freeze.
3. How do we get it to bounce back? We need to shove it into the enemy turret.
4. How do we do that? Well we can either slow push or fast push.
5. Fast pushing doesn't seem to do much here besides crash the wave, but slowing has a lot of

advantages here. The biggest of which is that we can set up a good dive as our jungler is pathing top. If we push too fast, the wave will crash and be cleared while our jungler is still clearing camps. So we choose to slow push.

6. Knowing our plan is to go for a dive if possible, we look for aggressive trades onto our opponent to chunk him as much as possible. Slow pushing also means our opponent has more time to make mistakes and get chunked. It also means if we want to reset or roam, we have more time to do so since the enemy needs to clear a bigger wave. Also, even if we trade 1 for 1, it's worth because the enemy loses the minion farm under their turret.

7. We crash the wave and see if jungler wants to dive or if you can execute it yourself. Yes? great! You reset and come back to lane as the wave bounces back. No? That's fine too, you just stick around or reset and come back to lane while the wave bounces back.

8. The result? You can set up a freeze now. + you might have an item and hp advantage at the same time.

9. Final note: What if you stick around after the crash (rather than resetting) but the enemy resets after clearing the wave? Well if you see that he's gone, you simply hard shove the bounce back wave back into his turret then you also reset. The enemy now loses an extra wave, and you come back to a bouncing back wave and can freeze like planned.

And yeah that's that. There's also a factor of enemy jungle here as well, which would deter the dive, which I didn't cover. I can't go through every scenario and every factor in a situation but I just wanted to go through an example here to kind of show what your thought process could look like. The more you do this, the more you'll just decide on these things instinctively. All these 9 steps will go through your head in seconds.

POST-LANE WAVE MANAGEMENT

A lot of players, especially in low elo, seem to forget that wave management concepts still apply even after both outer turrets fall.

Slow-pushing, fast pushing, and freezing still all exist. All too common players autopilot to hard shoving every single sidelane wave, when in reality, they could be securing or denying more farm.

****FREEZING****

Freezing post laning is a tool you can be using to claw back into the game, or to further deny resources if you're farming in the sidelane. (generally you always want to get mid prio asap)

If you're behind, pushing out a wave and waiting for your opponent to shove it back in inevitably will lead to a lot of lost farm. If you freeze, ****you can reliably and safely secure farm, while also forcing your opponent to extend**** to your tier 2 turret to get that wave shoved in which is potential set up for a gank.

While ahead, you can again, freeze to ****deny the enemy resources**** for as long as you want. It is harder to freeze at your tier two though, and to maintain it for a long time.

Now the most common thing people will respond to this is that: well then my laner just roams and my team will die 5v4. And so this is why you do need to make this decision according to the game state and also the way your team is playing. For example, playing against splitpushers or immobile juggernauts who have weak roams like illaoi, yorick, fiora, garen, etc. would make for a good game to freeze since it's much harder for them to make proactive plays outside of a forced objective teamfight or in the sidelane. It's also pretty good into immobile mages like viktor, syndra, anivia if you think your team can prevent a hard engage (Yes, a hyperaggressive team that just

fight fights fights, maybe you shouldn't try to do this; and yes that will be more common in low elo). If the enemy doesn't come to shove this wave in, they are just bleeding resources; but by walkomh far up to shove, they also make themselves quite vulnerable.

****SLOWPUSHING****

Slowpushing is also extremely important to remember. The reason why is best explained with an example imo.

Imagine both T1 turrets are gone, the wave has just bounced back from your turret. Say you fast push wave 1 (current wave), you can then fast push wave 2 probably around middle of the lane...but then wave 3 will be quite near the enemy tier 2 without crashing. So pushing in wave 3 is quite risky. That's a problem.

Now in many scenarios, you can crash the wave after fast pushing as long as the wave is a bit over the middle of the lane. So you can instead continuously slow push (well it's more that you're controlling the push speed) on your side of the map such that the crash zone eventually ends up slightly past the middle. After which you fast push and simply leave because it can now crash into the enemy turret. This is much safer than having to extend to enemy krug area to push in that last wave. And obviously, if you don't go there you're losing out on cs.

Hopefully this makes sense.

Slow pushing can also delay and time the wave just right to make it such that the wave has crashed or started to slow push back when you do need reset for an objective. This way you lose the least amount of minions possible. When the fight is over and you walk back to the sidelane you'll have

lost the least amount of minions. You also want the wave to be just crashing, or just bouncing back when you need to reset for an objective rather than already halfway or more than halfway shoving back towards your turret.

MISCELLANEOUS TIPS

There's a bunch of miscellaneous tips which you might find useful.

WHAT TO DO AFTER A KILL

One of the biggest questions people ask is what to do with a wave after a kill? The big dilemma people end up with is whether to reset now or later? In many scenarios, you may have to just take the loss, but here's a general and simple version of how to make your decision.

* **Do you have time to crash the wave?**

- * **If yes, is there a good chance the enemy jungle or anyone else is there to kill you?**

- * If yes, reset and take the loss (somewhat situational though, if the wave will freeze and you think it'll realllly screw you over, then I would take the risk or even die to fix the wave)

- * If no, shove then reset

- * If no, look at next bullet

* **Is the wave pushing away/bouncing away?**

- * If yes, reset. You don't have enough time to crash, so you just reset now to miss the least amount of minions (unless you need a couple more for a buy).

- * If no, next bullet

- * **If the wave is pushing towards you, is the wave trimmed such that if you reset and walk back it will be in relatively the same position (basically somewhat frozen)?**

- * If yes, reset
- * If no, next bullet
- * **Is it safe/enough time to trim the wave?**
- * If yes, trim then reset
- * If no, reset now

Now how much to trim the wave properly, will come with experience. [Here's an example of resetting off a trimmed wave tho.](<https://youtu.be/VF2msEnIqao>) Obviously, I didn't do this perfectly..at all.. but you can see how if I didn't trim it at all, I would have lost way more minions as the enemy wave would probably have crashed.

Also, the above bullets doesn't take into account teleport. If you have that then take it into account accordingly because it won't have to walk all the way back to lane. It means you might want to just stay and tp back later (talked about in the next section) or it'll save you from having to take a push risk since you can tp back to lane without losing much minions.

****USING TP TO GAIN ITEM/HP/WAVE ADVANTAGES****

Say you get a kill or force your opponent to reset or something of the sort. You might not be full hp or maybe you have some gold in your pocket. BUT consider not resetting yet. When your opponent gets back to lane, force trade as much with them as possible without getting killed - even if it's a bad trade. When you're too low, you then reset, tp back to lane, and now you're probably up a ton of hp and even items and your opponent is forced to stay and lane against you. If they try to reset to match, you basically have like 45 seconds to do whatever you want with the wave.

****TRICK TO FARM BUT NEVER INTERACT WITH YOUR OPPONENT IN A BAD**

MATCHUP/LOSING**

Talked about earlier but just wanted touch upon it again. This is a top lane strategy that you can use when you're behind or in a bad matchup, but not SO bad that they can 1v1 you inside your own wave. I've actually seen pros use this in their games.

The idea is:

1. Slowpush a wave to the enemy turret. (should work because you build up a wave so it's much harder for the enemy to all in you). You can freely trade hp to get the wave crashed.
2. Once crashed you reset and walk back to lane.
3. By the time you get back the wave will be pushing or close to crashing into your turret.
4. Rinse and repeat

It's that simple. You might lose out on a couple minions, but in this way, you can avoid all ins against your opponent because you constantly give yourself a big minion advantage while at the same time constantly resetting to refresh your hp (which lets you take bad trades to crash waves) and buying cheap items to get slight advantages.

It's a good way to try and prevent yourself from inting in a bad matchup or getting even more behind.

THE BEST WAY TO CATCH SOMEONE OUT POST LANE PHASE

If you want to get a pick during the mid game, the best way to do this is by catching someone off either while they rotate TO or FROM a crashed/crashing wave. A carry normally needs to be sent to catch a crashing wave or else it will be lost forever. Many players will rotate to a sidelane wave like

this either from mid lane or when they finish clearing it, will rotate back mid.

****Here's some good spots to sit to jump someone rotating from the sidelane to mid (assuming the t1 is gone):****

- * [The corner right around gromp (red dot area)](<https://imgur.com/a/a0rTmw1>)

- * [Walls across Krugs](<https://imgur.com/a/hQTPXUZ>)

- * Wolves

****Mid to sidelane:****

- * Blue buff bush

- * Red buff bushes

- * Red buff

- * Raptors

These places are good because with the way the enemy paths, they won't see you until they're basically standing right next to you due to how vision works with the curves of the terrain.

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****(During Laning) PRESSURING THE ENEMY BEYOND THEIR TURRET****

This is something you can do to hard push your lead further and is something you'll very commonly see in higher elos. A recommended prereq for this is to ward up the entrances to your lane or know where enemy allies are.

If you have a huge lead on your opponent, or some kind of advantage, ****you can essentially just proxy past the enemy tier 1, and then just stand their and prevent your lane opponent from walking to his tier 1 from his tier 2.**** If he tries to, you can just all in and kill them. But if he stays back and doesn't get to his tier 1, he just bleeds minions that are crashing. They can try to path around but (since you're winning hard) you should have the entrances to your lane warded meaning if you play right you can just meet them there if they try to path around. So either way he's screwed unless you get collapsed on by his teammates, which also means you're drawing pressure and should benefit your team so long as you're careful and don't meaninglessly die.

Obviously, you can also do this with a numbers advantage as well, for example if your jungle is invading nearby you can pressure this way. It's also not uncommon for a jungler or roaming mid to for example catch off bot laners walking back to lane between their t1 and t2.

[Here's a decent example. Not just limited to bot lane, of course.](<https://www.youtube.com/shorts/iUfJK6FgjjY>)

****PULLING WAVES****

As touched upon in the freezing section, pulling waves is something you can use while setting up freezes to:

1. ****drag the wave to a crash point that you want****
2. ****reduce minion damage taken before the next wave crashes and freezes****

Another application of pulling waves is for ****level 1s in top and bot lane****. The idea is before the first

wave crashes, you take full minion aggro then immediately use the bush to drop it. You'll take a bit of damage in return but what ends up happening is that the enemy minions now will all focus a single one of your melees instead of all 3 when it crashes. This means that if the enemy leashed, they could actually lose a full minion of exp if they're slow. It also means the wave will push into you faster at the start (which you might want in some matchups, especially top).

[Here's an example video on that.](<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LHcEv2R1JC4>)

****QUICK LEVEL 1 TIP FOR MELEE VS RANGED MATCHUP****

This is for the level 1 melee vs ranged matchup in solo lanes. Basically the start of every single melee vs ranged solo lane matchup goes like this: the melee has trouble stepping up to secure cs early without giving up hp while at the same time is unable to trade anything too meaningful back. It's very rare for a melee to have push level 1 into ranged champions without conceding a lot of hp. However, after level 3, the lane will equalize a bit as melees get their crucial abilities to counterpressure back or threaten all ins and be more of a threat to the ranged champ. Thus, you always want the wave to push into you somewhat fast at level 1. This way you'll lose less cs as you generally can't secure them all early as melee. So, as melee ****you can allow the enemy to auto you once so that they take aggro from your minions and the wave will shove into you faster.**** So the faster those first waves shove into you the less minions you end up losing.

****EXP****

Lastly, some info for when you hit levels 2 and

Level 2 for solo lanes:

* Either first wave +1 of next wave

* OR 4 melees and 2 casters

Level 3 for solo lanes: first 2 waves + 2 melees of 3rd wave

Level 2 for bot: First wave + 3 melees of next

Level 3 for bot: 3 waves + 3 melees from 4th

[So uh I went over the post character limit; here's a pic for proxying](<https://imgur.com/a/cvYgUzr>)

[Killing minions at the last split second (usages)](<https://imgur.com/a/H2srHBw>)

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But yeah that's all I got; I hope this was helpful in some way. Please do let me know if there's wrong information here, I will make sure to change it once I see it. (Gonna go to bed now though, so if there happens to be comments or questions, I'll respond to them when I wake up)

Oh lastly, since I've made a couple text guides like this one on this sub in the past people always like to ask how I have enough free time to write these. The answer is that I basically just work on it for like 20-30 minutes a day whenever I feel like it lol. I actually first started this guide back in November but I was too lazy since holiday season and all so I only really spent a couple days a week touching it if at all.

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 15]

This is fantastic and I'm definitely saving it for my low elo butt to keep referencing.

Also no need to justify your time usage, we're league players after all ?.

[Comment 2 | Score: 2]

Whenever someone gives wave management advice I just automatically know they're a top laner.

[Comment 3 | Score: 1]

Thanks!

[Comment 4 | Score: 1]

As a new League player/top main, thanks for the post

[Comment 5 | Score: 1]

I read every word. Thank you for making this so comprehensive.